PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

AM General Hummer H2

2003–2009 · GMT820-based · 6.0 LQ4 / 6.2 L92 V8 · BW 44-84 full-time · SUV · SUT

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Find out what the air suspension has been doing**
  If the rear compressor runs at every stop light, there's a leak somewhere and the compressor is cooking itself. One owner was quoted $2,250 for a GM compressor before labor. Many trucks have already been converted to coils, which owners say costs under $250 in parts. Check which you're buying and whether the onboard air hose still works.

- [ ] **Shake the front end**
  35-inch tires wear out ball joints, tie rods, pitman and idler arms and hub bearings, even in normal driving. Owners list the front ball joints and tie-rod ends as weak points. Budget roughly $400 in parts for a front-end rebuild before labor, and more if the torsion bars have been cranked.

- [ ] **Listen for a clunk from the front diff**
  The front differential hangs on three rubber bushings that soften with age, oil and coolant leaks. A loose diff clunks over bumps. Owners replace them with Outfitter Design's UHMW kit; one paid $400 to have it installed.

- [ ] **Cycle every 4WD mode**
  Shift through 4HI, 4HI Lock and 4LO Lock, and lock the rear diff in 4LO. A SERVICE 4WD message or a slow shift points to the encoder motor, the dash buttons or wiring. A bang followed by no 4WD at all usually means the plastic shift fork inside the transfer case has broken.

- [ ] **Look up at the roof and the sunroof**
  Owners keep naming water leaks from the roof clearance lights and the sunroof. Check the headliner, the carpet and the rear cargo area for stains or a musty smell.

- [ ] **Know which truck you want**
  2008–09 trucks have the 6.2, the six-speed and a far better interior, and owners say they're better 'in every way'. They also use some parts specific to those years, and 2009s are rare. 2003–07 trucks are cheaper and have more junkyard parts. Owners call the 4L65-E four-speed the drivetrain's weak link.

- [ ] **Inspect the chassis, not the chrome**
  Dealers can detail out a lot, but not rock gouges in the frame and skid plates. Lifts, tires and wiring added by previous owners are common, so trace any extra switches or lights, and run the VIN for open recalls.

YEARS TO KNOW

2003	RECALL	First-year recalls: two wiper-motor campaigns (02V283000, 08V456000), the key and shifter override (03V075000) and the Hydro-boost relief valve (04V045000, also 2004)
2004–2005	RECALL	Hydro-boost accumulator (05V043000) and second-row center seat belt routing (05V163000) recalls
2006–2009	RECALL	Heated washer fluid module recalls (08V441000, then 10V240000 after new fire reports)

2008	SWEET SPOT	Major update: 6.2 L L92 V8 (393 hp, 415 lb-ft), 6L80 six-speed, towing up to 8,000 lb, crawl ratio about 39:1, stronger transfer case, quicker steering, new interior with a rotary 4WD dial, curtain airbags and panic brake assist. Owners call the 2008–09 trucks the most refined H2s

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **Windshield wiper motor failure**
  2003 · NHTSA 02V283000
- ☐ **Ignition key / shift lever override**
  2003 · NHTSA 03V075000
- ☐ **Hydro-boost relief valve bore**
  2003–2004 · NHTSA 04V045000
- ☐ **Hydro-boost accumulator cracking**
  2004–2005 · NHTSA 05V043000
- ☐ **Second-row center seat belt routing**
  2004–2005 · NHTSA 05V163000
- ☐ **Power steering hose**
  2006 · NHTSA 05V455000
- ☐ **Tire and loading label**
  2006 · NHTSA 05V552000
- ☐ **ABS wheel-speed sensor wiring**
  2008 · NHTSA 07V373000
- ☐ **Heated washer fluid module (first campaign)**
  2006–2008 · NHTSA 08V441000
- ☐ **Water in the wiper motor module**
  2003 · NHTSA 08V456000

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **VIN**
  US H2 VINs begin 5GR (for example 5GRGN23U73H135443, a 2003 sold on Bring a Trailer). The owner's manual says the 8th character is the engine code: U is the 6.0 VORTEC 6000 (2004 manual) and 8 is the 6.2 (2008 manual). The 10th character is the model year.
- ☐ **2003–07 vs 2008–09**
  2008–09 trucks have larger grille openings, a bigger lower grille and silver-painted lower bumpers (earlier trucks' are black). Inside, the dash and gauges are new and a rotary dial replaces the 4WD push buttons.
- ☐ **SUT**
  The pickup has a short bed, a power Midgate window and a folding Midgate, an outside swing-away spare, and extra taillights in the lower rear bumper.
- ☐ **Options label**
  The Service Parts Identification label in the glovebox lists the VIN, paint and every production option. Look for ZM6, the GM option code for the self-leveling rear air suspension.
- ☐ **Parts that changed in 2008**
  Front hub bearings differ between 2003–07 and 2008–09 trucks (Kryptonite lists separate parts). Owners say the transfer case input spline also changed, because the 6L80's output shaft differs from the four-speed's.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/hummer/h2/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks